

St. Paisios advice about Daily Readings

a) On Scripture Reading: Read Little, But Absorb Much

"Don't rush through chapters like a scholar studying for an exam. Read a small passage—even one verse—and let it sink into your soul like a seed growing in good soil."

"It's better to read three lines from the Gospel with a prayerful heart than to finish the whole New Testament without attention."

*Spiritual Counsels Vol. 1: With Pain and Love for Modern Man

b) Apply Scripture to Your Struggle

"When you're tempted, hold onto a verse like a weapon. For example, if you're angry, repeat: *'Let not the sun go down on your wrath' (Eph. 4:26).* If you're afraid, say: *'The Lord is my helper; I will not fear' (Heb. 13:6)."*

"Scripture is medicine—take the dose you need for your sickness."

*Oral teachings (recorded in "Words of Life")

c) Read with Repentance

"When you read the Gospels, imagine Christ speaking directly to you. If a passage convicts you, don't justify yourself—repent, and God will enlighten you."

"The Bible is a mirror: if you look into it but walk away unchanged, you've gained nothing (James 1:23-24)."

*Spiritual Counsels Vol. 3: Spiritual Struggle

2. On Reading the Lives of the Saints: "Imitate Those Who Through Faith and Patience Inherit the Promises" (Heb. 6:12)

a) Saints as Spiritual Friends

"The saints are alive! They are not just stories—they are our friends in heaven, cheering us on. When you read their lives, you absorb their courage."

"If you're discouraged, read about St. John Chrysostom's exiles or St. Xenia's homelessness. Your trials will seem lighter."

*"The Saints: Models of Repentance" (Holy Monastery of St. Paisios)

b) Focus on Their Struggles, Not Just Miracles

"Don't just marvel at their miracles—study their humility. A saint's greatest power was their repentance. Even St. Peter denied Christ, but his tears saved him."

"When you read how saints fought passions like yours (lust, anger, pride), you'll find a path to victory."

*Spiritual Counsels Vol. 2: Spiritual Awakening

c) Let Their Words Guide You

"Keep a notebook of sayings from saints that strike your heart. When you're weak, re-read them like letters from a father."

"St. Basil says, *'A psalm is a tranquilizer for the soul.'* When your mind is troubled, read the Psalms or the words of the Desert Fathers."

*Elder Paisios' letters (Epistles)

3. Practical Tips for Daily Practice

Morning: "Start with a short Gospel reading (even 1-2 verses) and a saint's story at breakfast. Let it set the tone for your day."

Evening: "End with a Psalm (e.g., Psalm 50/51 for repentance) and reflect: *'Which saint's struggle mirrored mine today?'"

Struggling to Focus? "Light a candle, make the sign of the cross, and say: 'Lord, open my eyes to see wondrous things in Your law' (Ps. 119:18)."

St. Paisios taught

Scripture and the Lives of the Saints are **oxygen for the soul**. Breathe them in daily, but don't 'choke' by forcing too much at once.

Let them **convert your mind**, not just inform it. A single word from God can change your life if you hold onto it.